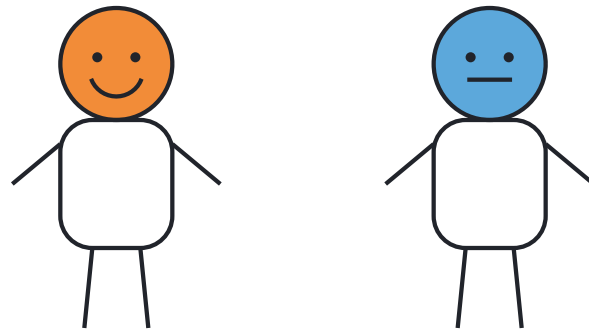




LITTLE FEELINGS SOCIAL STORIES



One Breath, One Step

Managing Overwhelm - An SEL Workbook With Breathing Cards

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 5-9 - SEL workbook + breathing cards

A read-aloud social story with activities

Home - Classroom - Counseling

How to Share This Book

Social stories gently walk a child through a situation and model calm, kind choices. Read this book together, more than once. The repetition is what helps - it lets a child rehearse the feelings and choices before the real moment happens.

This book helps a child understand the feeling, see that it is normal, and practice calm, kind choices - before the real moment happens.

How to use it

- Read the story slowly and out loud, pointing at the pictures.
- Read it again on calm days - not only in the hard moment.
- Pause to let your child color, answer, or act out the pages.
- Praise effort and calm tries, not perfection.
- Use the calm-down tools together so they feel familiar later.

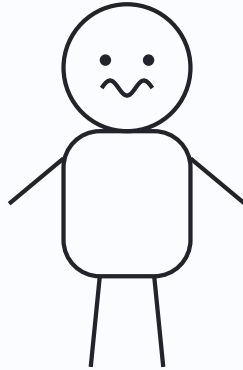
What's Inside

- 1 The Story: Too Much at Once
- 2 My Feelings Faces
- 3 One Step at a Time
- 4 Breathing Cards
- 5 What Would You Do?
- 6 My Overwhelm Plan
- 7 My Certificate



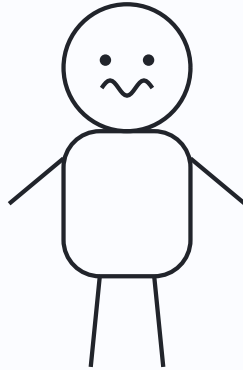
The Story

When Everything Feels Like Too Much



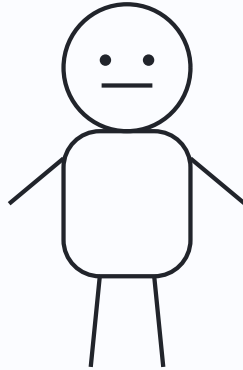
Sometimes I have SO much to do.

My thoughts get loud and everything feels like too much at once.



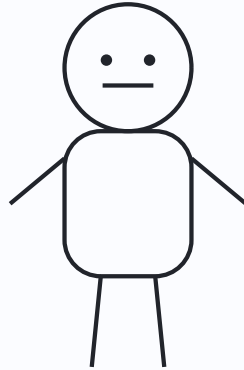
This big feeling is called being overwhelmed.

My body might feel tight, tired, or like I want to give up.



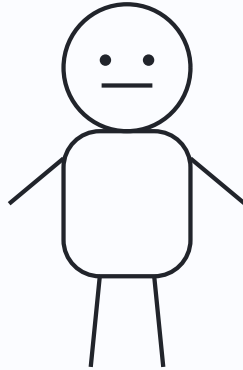
When I feel that way, I stop and take ONE breath.

One slow breath tells my body, 'You are safe. You can handle this.'



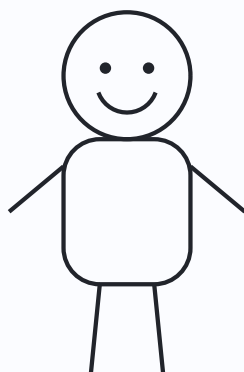
Then I take ONE small step.

I do not have to do everything at once - just the next small thing.



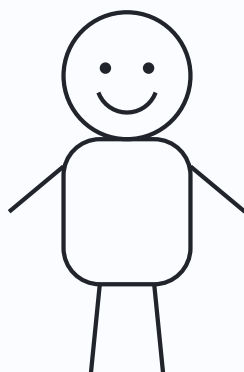
Big things feel smaller when I break them into pieces.

One breath. One step. Then another.



If it is still too much, I ask for help.

Asking for help is a smart and brave thing to do.



Little by little, I get it done.

I feel proud. One breath and one step at a time really works.

Overwhelmed Feelings

Color each face. Say the feeling out loud.



Overwhelmed



Tired



Frustrated



Calmer



Capable



Proud

One Step at a Time

- **Something that feels like too much right now is...**

- **The very first small step I can take is...**

- **Who can help me if I need it?**

Square Breathing

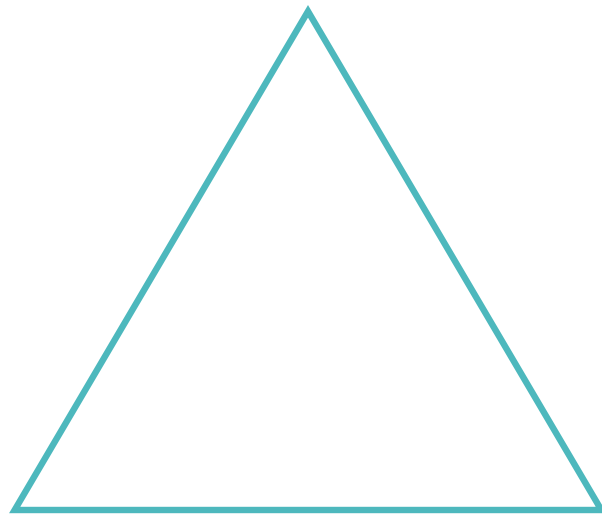
Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it a few times until your body feels calmer.



1. Breathe in for 4 as you trace up.
2. Hold for 4 across the top.
3. Breathe out for 4 down the side.
4. Hold for 4 across the bottom.

Triangle Breathing

Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it a few times until your body feels calmer.



1. Breathe in as you trace the first side.
2. Hold as you trace the second side.
3. Breathe out as you trace the last side.
4. Go around slowly a few times.

What Would You Do?

Read each situation together. There are many good choices! Talk it through, then write or draw what you could do.

- 1 You have homework, chores, and practice all in one evening.**

What could you do?

- 2 Your room is a huge mess and you don't know where to start.**

What could you do?

- 3 Too many kids are talking to you at once and it feels loud.**

What could you do?

My Overwhelm Plan

● When I feel overwhelmed, my first move is...

● My favorite breathing tool is...

● How I break big things into small steps...

My Calm-Down Toolkit

Out of all the tools in this book, which ones help YOU most? Draw or write your top tools here so you remember them when a big feeling comes.

1

2

3

4

5

What I Learned

- The most helpful thing I learned was...

- One thing I will try next time is...

My Feelings Journal

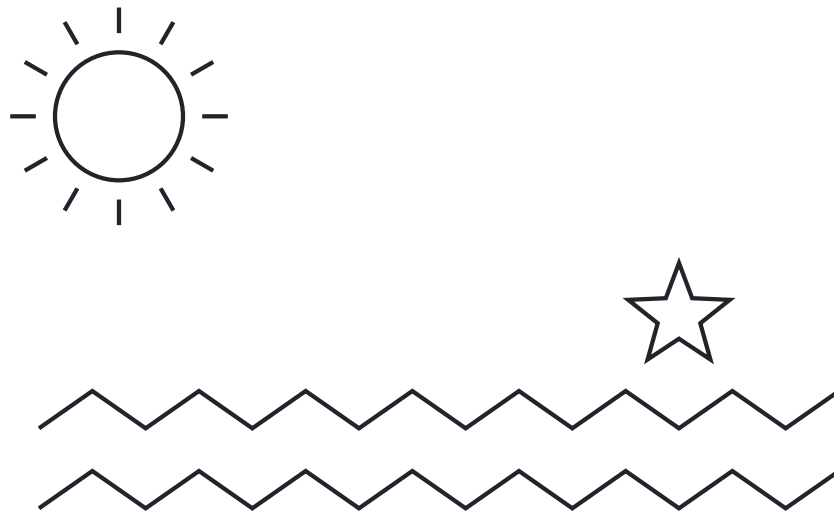
● A time I felt this feeling was...

● What helped me feel better was...

COLOR

My Calm Place

Draw and color a place where you feel calm and safe.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

Calm Words to Trace

Trace the words. Then say them out loud.

I am safe.

I can ask for help.

This will pass.

People Who Help Me

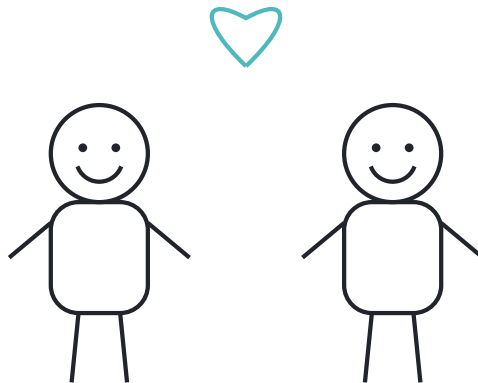
● Who are my safe grown-ups?

● How can they help me?

COLOR

Happy Together

Color two friends being kind to each other.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

My Feelings Journal

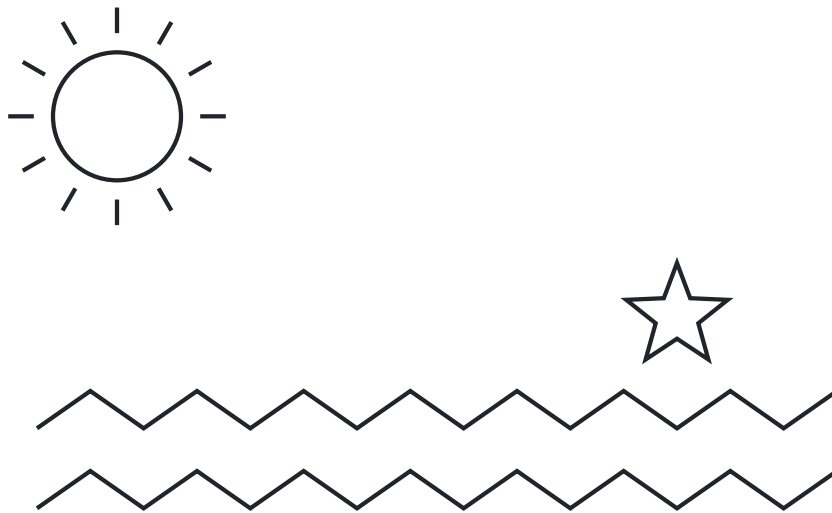
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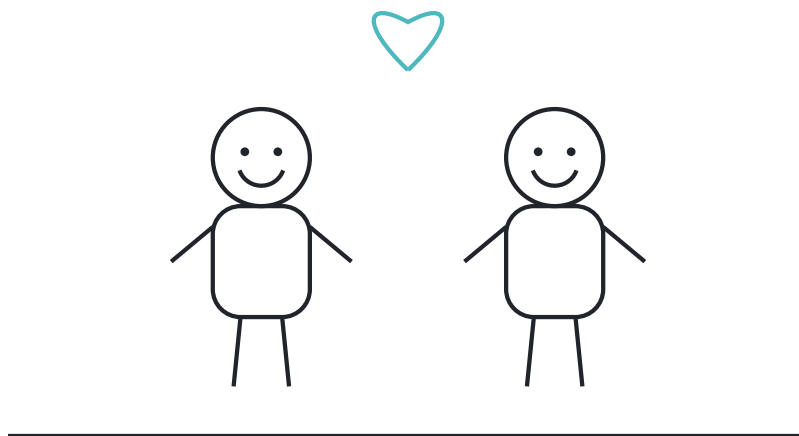
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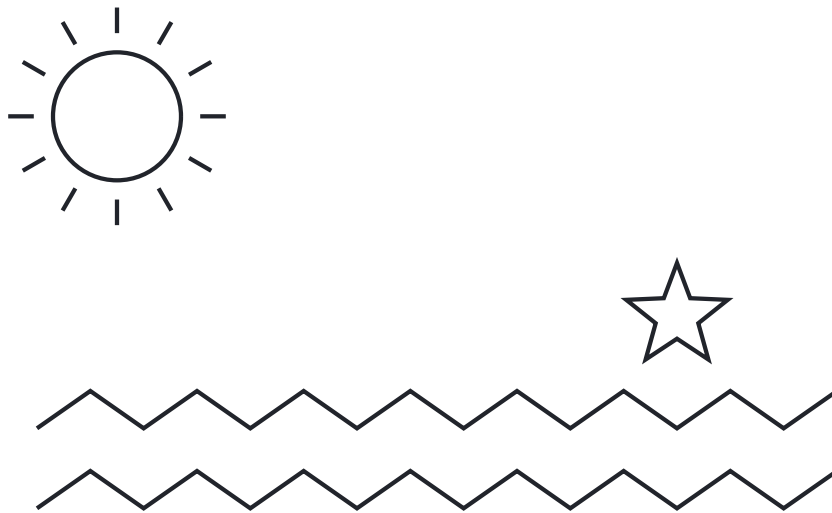
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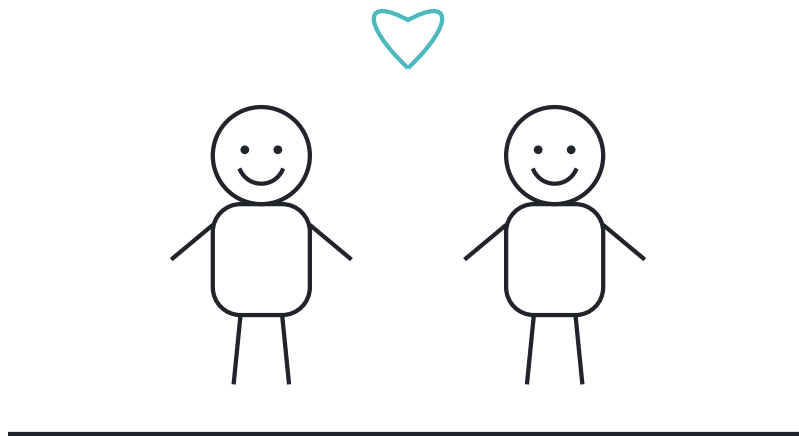
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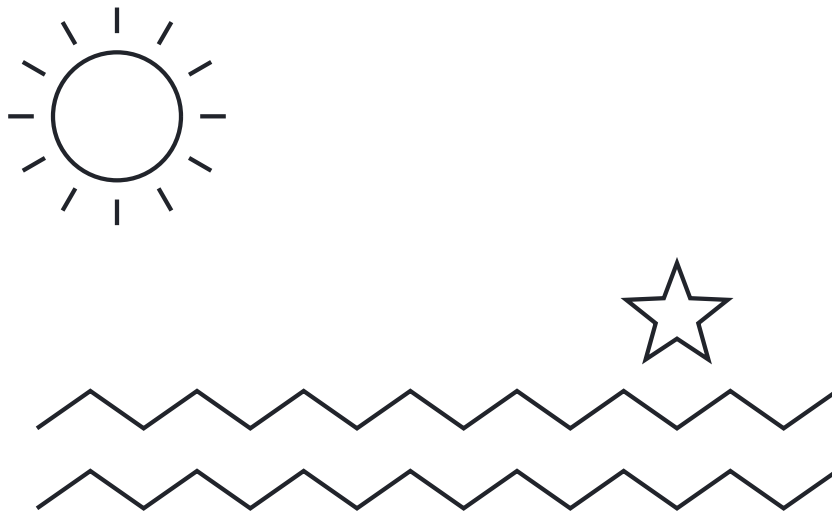
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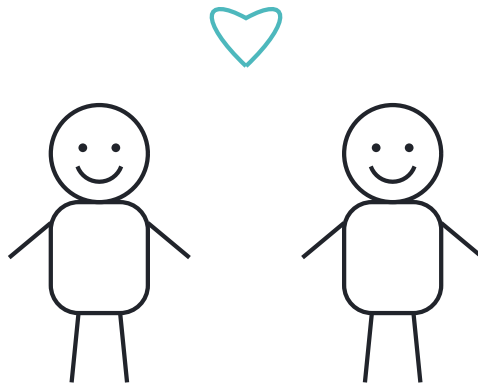
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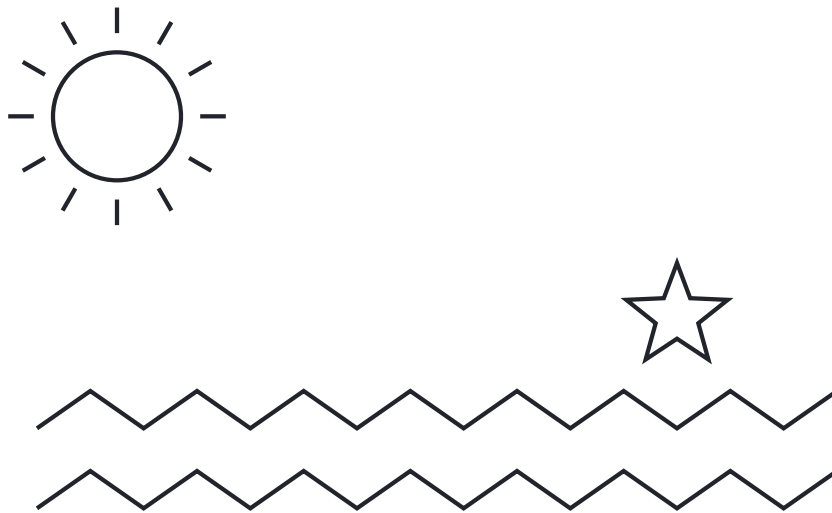
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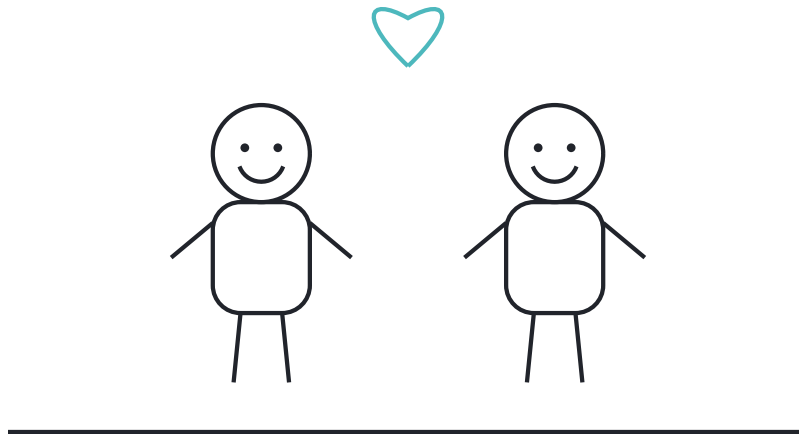
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CERTIFICATE

This certificate is proudly given to

(write your name)

for learning to take one breath and one step at a time!

Grown-up

Date